

Milestone Birthday Card Copy

80 card fronts – 30th, 40th, 70th and 80th
four formats, five cards each

Built from eRank keyword and top-listing research.
Each milestone opens with its target phrase.

Before you build these

Read this page first.

You have 80 concepts and 4 viable phrases.

This is a bank, not a listing plan. Every card inside a milestone section targets the same search phrase, so listing all 20 would split their own ranking rather than the market's. Pick one card per phrase to list first, hold the rest for phrases you turn up later.

Tone shifts as the number climbs.

30th and 40th cards are bought peer-to-peer, so profanity and aging humor land. 70th and 80th cards are usually bought by adult children and grandchildren, so those sections are written admiring rather than mocking. Same formats, different edge.

Pricing from the research.

Median price in the 40th top 100 is \$4.99, but every top seller sits at \$6.50 to \$7.04. Price above the median.

Timelines differ by keyword.

The 40th keyword has a median listing age of 2.4 years, so a new card there may take months to move. The 80th phrase has one tag occurrence and far less depth. Do not read a slow 40th listing as a failed card.

The formats

- A Heavy bold sans, ALL CAPS, left-aligned. One long sentence.
- B Typewriter, sentence case, centered. Short and warm.
- C Typewriter, ALL CAPS, centered. Punchline inside a quote.
- D Typewriter, lowercase, left-aligned. One dry line.

30th Birthday

Target phrase: "30th birthday card" — 1,255 searches / KD 49 / 12 tag occurrences

Format A — Heavy bold sans, ALL CAPS, left-aligned

One long sentence filling the card. Blunt, a little profane, oddly supportive.

- 01 I'M NOT GOING TO PRETEND THIRTY ISN'T A BIG DEAL BUT I AM GOING TO PRETEND I DIDN'T SEE YOU CRY ABOUT IT.

- 02 WELCOME TO THIRTY WHERE EVERY SINGLE PERSON YOU KNOW SUDDENLY HAS A MORTGAGE AND AN OPINION ABOUT MATTRESSES.

- 03 THIRTY IS WHEN YOU STOP ASKING WHAT'S WRONG WITH YOUR BACK AND START ACCEPTING IT AS A PERSONALITY TRAIT.

- 04 I CAN'T MAKE THIRTY EASIER BUT I CAN CONFIRM THAT NOBODY ELSE HAS ANY IDEA WHAT THEY ARE DOING EITHER.

- 05 CONGRATULATIONS ON THE AGE WHERE STAYING OUT PAST ELEVEN REQUIRES A NAP, A PLAN, AND A REASON.

Format B — Typewriter, sentence case, centered

Short and warm. Reads like a note, not a joke.

- 01 happy 30th. the good news is nobody has it figured out. the bad news is they're all pretending they do.

- 02 thirty looks good on you. the panic looks good on you too.

- 03 you made it through your twenties. barely, but nobody has to know that.

- 04 happy birthday. same you, better excuses.

- 05 thirty years of you and i still haven't gotten bored. that's a hell of a record.

Format C — Typewriter, ALL CAPS, centered

Observational build. Punchline lands inside a quote.

01 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE TURNING THIRTY AND HEARING A SONG FROM HIGH SCHOOL ON THE
 OLDIES STATION AND THINKING "SURELY NOT."

02 NOTHING PREPARES YOU FOR SLEEPING SLIGHTLY WRONG AT THIRTY AND SPENDING FOUR
 DAYS THINKING "I GUESS THIS IS MY NECK NOW."

03 THERE IS NO WORSE MOMENT THAN STANDING UP AT THIRTY AND HEARING A NOISE COME
 OUT OF YOU AND THINKING "THAT WAS ME."

04 NOTHING HUMBLER YOU LIKE LOOKING AT A BAR LINE AT THIRTY AND THINKING "I COULD
 JUST GO HOME AND NOBODY WOULD STOP ME."

05 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE SOMEONE HALF YOUR AGE HOLDING A DOOR FOR YOU AND THINKING
 "I HAVE MADE A MISTAKE SOMEWHERE."

Format D — Typewriter, lowercase, left-aligned, short lines

One dry line. No setup, no kicker.

01 thirty is when your body starts sending you notifications

02 the first thirty years are always the hardest

03 you're not old, you're just out of warranty

04 congratulations on aging out of your own target demographic

05 thirty. still no idea. now with less energy.

40th Birthday

Target phrase: "40th birthday card" — 720 searches / 1,020 clicks / KD 59 / 95 tag occurrences

Format A — Heavy bold sans, ALL CAPS, left-aligned

One long sentence filling the card. Blunt, a little profane, oddly supportive.

- 01 **THERE IS NO GENTLE WAY TO SAY THIS SO I'M JUST GOING TO SAY IT: YOU ARE OLD AS HELL AND I LOVE YOU.**

- 02 **I DIDN'T GET YOU A GIFT BECAUSE NOTHING I COULD BUY WOULD FIX WHAT IS ABOUT TO HAPPEN TO YOUR KNEES.**

- 03 **CONGRATULATIONS ON REACHING THE AGE WHERE YOUR BODY MAKES A NOISE EVERY TIME YOU STAND UP AND NOBODY EVEN COMMENTS ON IT ANYMORE.**

- 04 **I CAN'T MAKE TURNING FORTY ANY EASIER BUT I CAN CONFIRM THAT EVERYONE ELSE IS QUIETLY FALLING APART TOO.**

- 05 **FORTY IS WHEN YOU REALIZE THE PEOPLE RUNNING EVERYTHING ARE EXACTLY YOUR AGE AND THAT SHOULD TERRIFY ALL OF US.**

Format B — Typewriter, sentence case, centered

Short and warm. Reads like a note, not a joke.

- 01 happy 40th. you've earned every one of those years and most of that damage.

- 02 forty. same person, worse back, better taste.

- 03 thank you for aging at roughly the same rate as me. it's the only reason i feel
okay about any of this.

- 04 happy birthday. you're officially old enough to stop explaining yourself to
anyone.

- 05 forty years in and you're still the most interesting person in the room.
annoyingly.

Format C — Typewriter, ALL CAPS, centered

Observational build. Punchline lands inside a quote.

- 01 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE HOLDING A MENU IN DIM LIGHTING AT FORTY AND THINKING "I AM
GOING TO HAVE TO ADMIT SOMETHING TODAY."
-
- 02 NOTHING PREPARES YOU FOR WALKING INTO A LOUD RESTAURANT AT FORTY AND
IMMEDIATELY THINKING "THIS IS A LOT."
-
- 03 THERE IS NOTHING SCARIER THAN BENDING DOWN AT FORTY AND YOUR BODY GOING "IS
THERE ANYTHING ELSE WHILE WE'RE DOWN HERE?"
-
- 04 NOTHING HUMBLER YOU LIKE HEARING A SONG FROM YOUR CHILDHOOD IN A GROCERY STORE
AND THINKING "THEY'RE PLAYING THIS IRONICALLY."
-
- 05 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE MEETING SOMEONE BORN THE YEAR YOU GRADUATED AND THINKING
"THAT PERSON IS ALLOWED TO VOTE."

Format D — Typewriter, lowercase, left-aligned, short lines

One dry line. No setup, no kicker.

- 01 you're not old, you're just older than the internet
-
- 02 the first forty years are always the hardest
-
- 03 you've officially been alive longer than most of my excuses
-
- 04 forty. old enough to know better. still not doing it.
-
- 05 congratulations on outliving every trend that ever embarrassed you

70th Birthday

Adjacent phrase: "70th birthday gift" – 1,195 searches / KD 60 / 1 tag occurrence

Format A — Heavy bold sans, ALL CAPS, left-aligned

One long sentence filling the card. Blunt, a little profane, oddly supportive.

- 01 SEVENTY YEARS OF EXPERIENCE AND YOU STILL DO WHATEVER YOU WANT, WHICH IS FRANKLY THE WHOLE POINT.

- 02 THERE IS NO POLITE WAY TO SAY THIS SO HERE IT IS: YOU HAVE OUTLASTED EVERYONE WHO EVER DOUBTED YOU.

- 03 CONGRATULATIONS ON REACHING THE AGE WHERE YOU CAN SAY ABSOLUTELY ANYTHING AND EVERYONE JUST HAS TO SIT THERE AND TAKE IT.

- 04 I DIDN'T GET YOU ADVICE BECAUSE AT SEVENTY YOU HAVE HEARD ALL OF IT AND SUCCESSFULLY IGNORED MOST OF IT.

- 05 SEVENTY IS WHEN YOU STOP APOLOGIZING FOR LEAVING EARLY AND START ANNOUNCING IT AT THE DOOR ON THE WAY IN.

Format B — Typewriter, sentence case, centered

Short and warm. Reads like a note, not a joke.

- 01 happy 70th. seventy years and you still haven't run out of opinions.

- 02 seventy looks good on you. so does not caring what anyone thinks about it.

- 03 you've earned the naps, the volume, and the right to leave whenever you want.

- 04 happy birthday to someone who has never taken the easy way and never once complained about it.

- 05 seventy years in and you're still the one everybody calls first.

Format C — Typewriter, ALL CAPS, centered

Observational build. Punchline lands inside a quote.

01 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE REACHING SEVENTY AND WATCHING A YOUNG PERSON EXPLAIN
 SOMETHING YOU DID FOR THIRTY YEARS.

02 NOTHING PREPARES YOU FOR HEARING THE MUSIC OF YOUR YOUTH IN AN ELEVATOR AND
 THINKING "THIS WAS DANGEROUS ONCE."

03 THERE IS NO BETTER MOMENT THAN LEAVING A PARTY AT SEVENTY AND NOT GIVING A
 SINGLE EXPLANATION TO ANYONE.

04 NOTHING HUMBLER THAN A DOCTOR YOUNGER THAN YOUR SHOES TELLING YOU TO SLOW
 DOWN.

05 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE SEVENTY YEARS OF PRACTICE AND SOMEONE STILL ASKING IF YOU
 NEED HELP WITH THAT.

Format D — Typewriter, lowercase, left-aligned, short lines

One dry line. No setup, no kicker.

01 seventy years and you still won't ask for directions

02 the first seventy years are always the hardest

03 you've been alive longer than most of the things people call classic

04 seventy. still stubborn. still right.

05 old enough to say it, young enough to enjoy the reaction

80th Birthday

Target phrase: "80th birthday card" – 294 searches / KD 53 / 1 tag occurrence

Format A — Heavy bold sans, ALL CAPS, left-aligned

One long sentence filling the card. Blunt, a little profane, oddly supportive.

- 01 **EIGHTY YEARS ON THIS PLANET AND YOU STILL HAVE NOT TAKEN A SINGLE PIECE OF ADVICE FROM ANYONE.**

- 02 **CONGRATULATIONS ON REACHING THE AGE WHERE NOBODY IS ALLOWED TO TELL YOU WHAT TO DO ABOUT ANYTHING EVER AGAIN.**

- 03 **THERE IS NO POLITE WAY TO PUT THIS SO HERE IT IS: YOU HAVE BEEN RIGHT ABOUT ALMOST EVERYTHING AND WE ARE ALL TIRED OF IT.**

- 04 **EIGHTY IS WHEN THE STORIES GET BETTER AND THERE IS NOBODY LEFT AROUND TO CORRECT THEM.**

- 05 **I DIDN'T GET YOU ANYTHING PRACTICAL BECAUSE AT EIGHTY YOU HAVE ALREADY BOUGHT EVERYTHING YOU ACTUALLY WANTED.**

Format B — Typewriter, sentence case, centered

Short and warm. Reads like a note, not a joke.

- 01 happy 80th. eighty years and you still won't let anyone else drive.

- 02 eighty looks good on you. so does refusing to slow down about it.

- 03 you've earned every story, and most of them are even true.

- 04 happy birthday to the one person in this family who has never needed anyone's permission.

- 05 eighty years in and you're still the loudest one at the table. don't change.

Format C — Typewriter, ALL CAPS, centered

Observational build. Punchline lands inside a quote.

01 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE EIGHTY YEARS OF DOING SOMETHING AND SOMEONE HANDING YOU A
PAMPHLET ABOUT IT.

02 NOTHING PREPARES YOU FOR SEEING YOUR CHILDHOOD IN A MUSEUM AND THINKING "I
OWNED THAT."

03 THERE IS NO BETTER MOMENT THAN BEING EIGHTY AND SAYING THE THING EVERYONE ELSE
WAS ONLY THINKING.

04 NOTHING HUMBLER YOU LIKE OUTLIVING THE DOCTOR WHO TOLD YOU TO CUT BACK.

05 THERE'S NOTHING LIKE BEING EIGHTY AND STILL BEING THE FIRST ONE UP IN THE
HOUSE.

Format D — Typewriter, lowercase, left-aligned, short lines

One dry line. No setup, no kicker.

01 eighty years and you still won't let anyone else drive

02 the first eighty years are always the hardest

03 old enough to remember when all of this was a field

04 eighty. still sharp. still not listening.

05 eighty candles. one wish. probably about the thermostat.